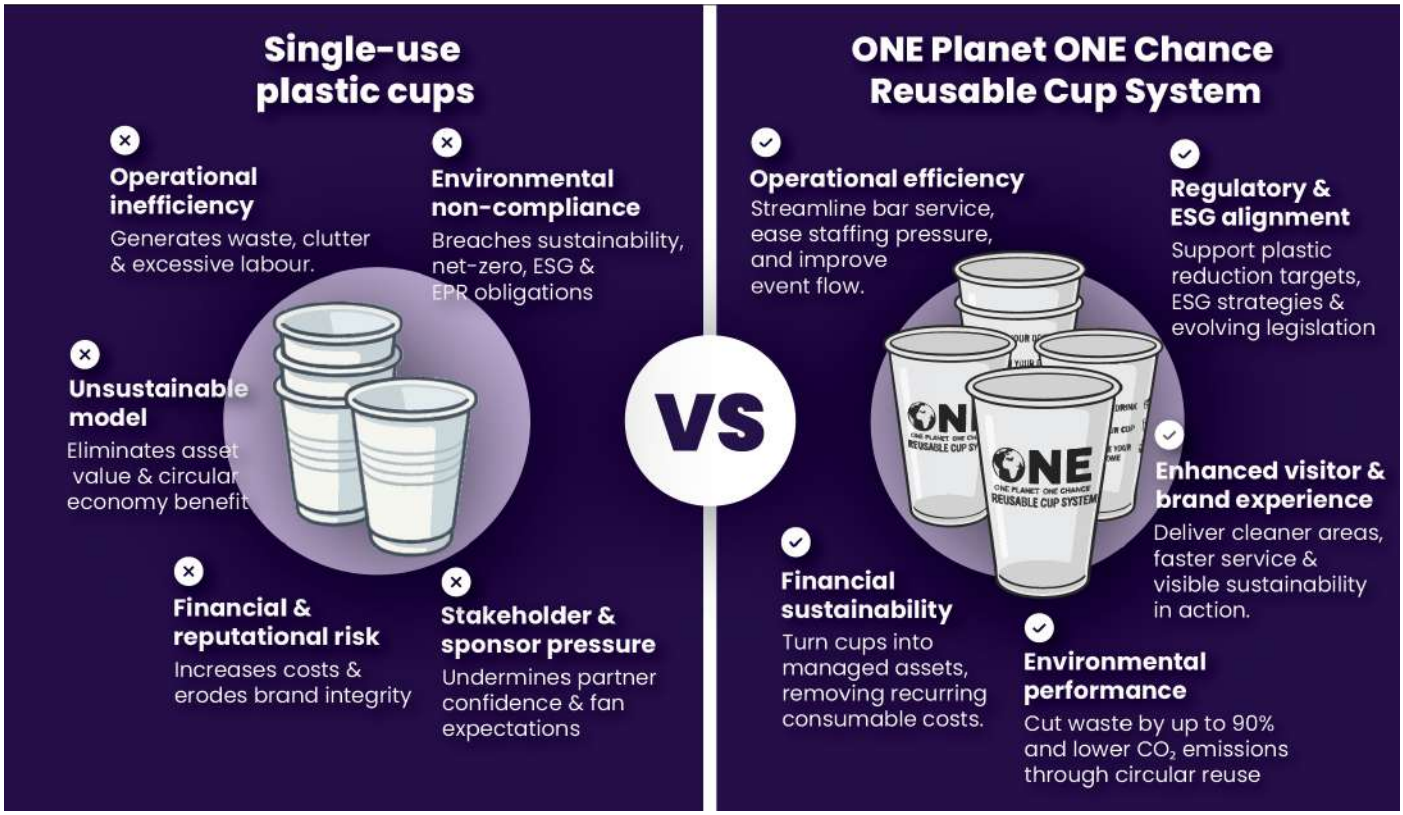
INDOOR ARENAS

Sector Case Study

Sector Overview

The UK indoor arena sector is booming. Hosting the biggest names in music, sport, comedy and touring shows, these sites operate year-round, providing the perfect venues for all types of entertainment. From national arenas with 20,000+ capacity to regional venues welcoming thousands of attendees per event, all serving many thousands of drinks per night across multiple weekly events. Peak demand before shows and during intervals generates high volumes of single-use waste, mainly plastic cups and food packaging, making traditional systems increasingly costly, inefficient and reputationally risky, while higher spill rates add further safety concerns in busy concourse areas. Many of the UK's largest arenas have made the switch to reusables using the ONE Planet ONE Chance ® Reusable Cup System which has eliminated waste from cups, increased their sustainability performance and improved their customer experience.



Why Reusable Cups?

Reusable cup systems are ideal for high-volume, fast-paced events, replacing single-use cups to cut waste by over 90% while reducing disposal costs and easing pressure on back-of-house teams. By switching to sustainable, reusable solutions, venues can visibly support ESG commitments and deliver a better visitor experience.

Closer To Our Customers

Trusted by leading venues around the UK

Event Cup Solutions partners with many of the UK's leading indoor arenas, including Co-op Live, The O2 Arena and OVO Hydro, alongside other regional venues nationwide.

Each year, we process millions of reusable cups with our rental-based system, helping to support venues in meeting their operational and sustainability targets.

How Does It Work?

- Our model is rental-based, so you have no capital outlay for cups.
- Our polypropylene cups feature our ONE Planet ONE Chance® branding, which delivers higher return rates than custom-branded cups.
- We offer supply-only or part-managed (on-site support) options, and will tailor the solution to your venue's needs.
- We track stock movement per event for full transparency, and you can carry out your own stock checks whenever it suits your team.

The Now & The Future

Case in point - Co-op Live, Manchester

In 2024, Europe's largest indoor arena, Co-op Live, opened its doors in Manchester. Billed as Europe's most sustainable arena, Co-op Live selected Event Cup Solutions and the ONE Planet ONE Chance® Reusable Cup System as the best solution to support its sustainability ambitions while delivering a seamless guest experience at scale.

1.5M+
Reusable Cups Used Annually

150+
Events Per Year

A dedicated local wash centre in Middleton, less than 7 miles from the arena, enables a closed-loop system where clean cups are delivered while used cups are collected for washing, reducing transport miles and CO2e emissions. Event Cup Solutions provide a part-managed service, with Cup Crew teams ensuring bars are fully stocked before events and all cups are collected and returned for reprocessing afterwards.

Sustainability

- ClimatePartner Certified
- Full emissions calculation
- Clear reduction targets
- Transparently reported
- Responsible offset program

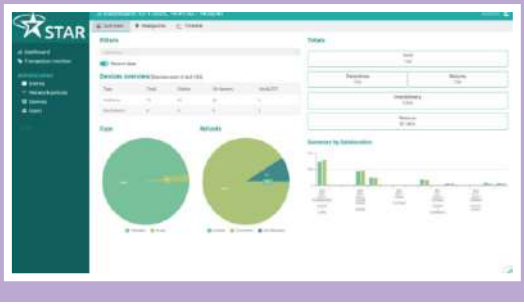
ClimatePartner certified company
climate-id.com/CCF1G8

CO_2
measure
reduce
contribute

Technology & Innovation

ONE SMART Reusable Cup System:

- RFID cups link to payment card
- Contactless auto-refund deposits
- Eliminates fraud and theft
- Real-time tracking dashboards
- 97–98% retention rates



Looking to the future...

- Reuse is expanding as visitor expectations and legislation increase.
- ECS continues to invest in RFID technology and wash network growth.
- Positioned as a long-term sustainability partner for venues.
- Mission: a wash centre within 50km of every serviced venue.
- This model is independently verified as the most sustainable approach for stadia and venues.

Ready to talk about reusable cup systems for YOUR venue? Contact the experts today.